



## MELTING ICE

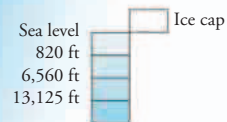
Warmer temperatures in summer cause chunks of ice at the edge of the ice sheet to calve, or break off, into the sea. In 2000, a giant piece of ice calved from the Ross Ice Shelf had a vast surface area of about 4,247 sq miles (11,000 sq km), which is larger than the Caribbean island of Jamaica.

This line marks how far sea ice retreats in summer, breaking up when the temperature rises. In the winter the ice extends much further.



## KEY

### Elevation



- ▲ Mountain
- Research station
- Limit of summer pack ice
- Limit of winter pack ice
- Ice shelf
- Limit of ice shelf
- Glacier

Scale 1:22,000,000

